Reading LaTeX in Nota

The Nota preview

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Abstract

Nota reads an article-level subset of LaTeX and lays it out to be read — not to be typeset. The preamble above renders nothing at all; only the title, the author and the date were taken out of it.

1 Text

Paragraphs are parted by a blank line, and a source line break is just a space, so this sentence runs on.

You can set text **bold**, *italic*, *emphasised*, `monospaced`, underlined and SMALL CAPS, and nest them: ***both at once***.

Punctuation is TeX's: 'single quotes', "double quotes", an en–dash, an em—dash, a non breaking space, and an ellipsis… A hard break comes from a double backslash,
like that.

A footnote [Which shows as a bracketed note in the secondary colour, right where the mark stood.] sits in the running text. So do citations [knuth1984] and cross-references to Section (sec:maths) and to Equation (eq:gauss). Links are clickable: https://example.com and a named link.

1.1 Lists

- Bullets, from `itemize`.
- They nest:
  1. Numbered, from `enumerate`.
  2. And the numbers count.
- Back out at the first level.

  Block sync Clicking a block here puts the caret on its source.

  Both ways Moving the caret over there lights the block here.

1.1.1 Quotations

> A quoted paragraph takes a leading hairline bar, the same one a Markdown block quote gets.

2 Maths

Inline maths sits in the sentence: the roots are $x = \frac{-b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - 4ac}}{2a}$, Euler's identity is $e^{i\pi} + 1 = 0$, and $a^2 + b^2 = c^2$ is Pythagoras.

An unnumbered display formula stands on its own:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{\sin x}{x} = 1$$

A numbered one carries its number at the trailing edge:

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-x^2}\,dx = \sqrt{\pi} \tag{1}$$

An `align` splits on the double backslash, drops the alignment ampersands, and numbers every row in its own right:

$$(a+b)^2 = a^2 + 2ab + b^2 \tag{2}$$

$$(a-b)^2 = a^2 - 2ab + b^2 \tag{3}$$

A starred environment is unnumbered:

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} i = \frac{n(n+1)}{2}$$

3 Blocks

3.1 Code

Verbatim is untouched — the dollars and backslashes in here are characters, not delimiters:

```
for i in 1..$n; do
    echo "$i \frac{1}{2}"
done
```

3.2 Tables

Environment	Rows	Numbered
equation	1	yes
align	many	every row
gather*	many	no

Table 1: What the maths environments do.

3.3 Pictures

An `\includegraphics` whose path resolves beside this file draws the picture; one that resolves to nothing shows the path instead, as this one does:

diagram

Figure 1: A picture that is not there.

4 What the subset has never heard of

A command it does not know renders as its own raw source, inline in the code-span style: `\marginpar{like this one}`. So does a use of the `\newcommand` from the preamble: `\nota`.

An environment it does not know renders whole, as a code block:

```
\begin{theorem}
Every unknown environment comes back as itself. Never a blank, never a broken
page --- the same rule the maths engine keeps.
\end{theorem}
```

That is the whole of it.